

Henry Morton Stanley
Berlin Conference
Topic: Imperial Interests

The Berlin conference was a crucial part of modern history and forever changed the political atmosphere of the time as well as the future of Africa as a whole. While most of the actual carving of african borders didn't happen until later years the berlin conference set the standard for the colonization of africa. Among many things such as the drawing the borders of belgian congo and the passing of the General act another crucial agreement was made "The Principle of effective occupation" allowing any power the right to colonial land so long as they were capable of governing the land meaning any colonial claim was openly recognized by all colonial nations. This led to a wave of african colonization known as the african scramble that eventually led to the almost complete annexation of africa to colonial powers.

Previous to the Berlin conference there was 1 major agreement named the anglo-french agreement this agreement settled a colonial dispute between the britain and france regarding conflicting african territory. The outcome of this agreement had both sides recognize each other's colonial territories as well as their respective spheres of influence; this resulted in neither nation getting in each other's way in regards to colonial expansion. This agreement was a success with no colonial wars between the two nations.

I, Henry Morton Stanley, am a British-American Explorer, Journalist and soldier. Despite not being a Belgian myself I represent the Belgian claims on the Congo after failing to gain British interest in the region. Belgium seeks that the berlin conference recognize their claim to the "Congo free state" These claims would allow the uncontested colonization of the region which the belgians sought for its rich resources and large populations. Before the conference I had charted trade routes and created claims within the Congo for Belgium. I am against the slave trade for acts I had Witnessed caused by the slave trade. I seek that the Congo is recognized by the committee as the rightful and legal territory of the Belgian Government and that any and all claims of the land are recognized. I also seek the abolition of slavery and the transatlantic slave trade.